FREE GUIDE

RIGHTSIZING IN CARROLL COUNTY, MARYLAND + PENNSYLVANIA

Your Next *Chapter* Guide

For families who need more land, less upkeep, or simply a home that fits the life you actually live.



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STEP ONE

Is it time for *your next chapter?*

Check every one that sounds like your house right now.

- [ ] You spend more Saturdays cleaning rooms nobody uses than enjoying them.
- [ ] You're gone every weekend for travel sports and the yard still needs mowing.
- [ ] The kids share rooms and there's nowhere to spread out.
- [ ] You have plenty of house but no land to roam.
- [ ] Stairs, upkeep or utility bills feel heavier every year.
- [ ] The kids moved out and the quiet feels too big.
- [ ] You want a shorter drive to work, school or the fields.
- [ ] You're heating and cooling space you never use.
- [ ] You want room for a garden, animals, a workshop or a pool.
- [ ] You've said "someday" for more than a year.

Checked 3 or more? It's worth a 20 minute conversation. Not a commitment. Just a plan, so you know your options before life decides for you.

STEP TWO

Which move *fits you?*

Rightsizing isn't always smaller. It's the home that fits this season of your family.

Move up

More room for a growing family

- Bedrooms for everyone
- A real mudroom for the sports gear
- A yard the kids and dog can use
- Space to work from home

Move down

Less upkeep, more life

- Main level living
- A smaller yard or no mowing at all
- Lower monthly costs
- Lock and leave for tournament weekends

Move out

More land, maybe less house

- Acreage instead of square footage
- Room for animals, gardens or a shop
- Quiet roads and big skies
- A house sized for how you live

Ask yourself: What do we actually use every week? What do we pay for but never use? Where do we want to be on a Saturday morning in 5 years?

STEP THREE

Buy first or *sell first?*

This is the question every family asks me. There's more than one right answer, and the best one depends on your numbers.

Sell first

You know exactly what you have to spend. Ask for extra time before settlement or a short rent back so you aren't moving twice.

Best when your equity is your down payment.

Buy first

You move once and on your schedule. Your lender helps you see if you can carry both homes for a short time or use your equity to buy before you sell.

Best when you have strong savings or equity options.

Buy with a home sale contingency

Your offer depends on your current home selling. It can work well with the right seller and the right timing.

Best when your home is priced and prepped to sell fast.

Line up both at once

We time both settlements on the same day or week so you move straight from one home to the next.

Best with a clear plan and a great team.

> Your lender and I will map the option that fits your numbers and your calendar, including those travel sports weekends.

STEP FOUR

Know *your numbers*

Fill in what you know. I'll help with the rest using real Carroll County sales, not an online guess.

What my home could sell for	_____
Minus what I still owe	_____
Minus selling costs and any prep	_____
Equity I can use for the next home	_____
Monthly payment I'm comfortable with	_____
Must haves (bedrooms, land, main level, garage)	_____
Towns or school areas I want to be near	_____
When I'd love to be moved in	_____

Free for you: I'll send a custom home value report and a side by side of what your next home could look like. Just reply with your address.

STEP FIVE

Get your home *ready*

Sort room by room

- Keep: what you use and love
- Give: to the kids, family or friends
- Sell: furniture and gear that won't fit
- Store: only what's truly seasonal

Start with the room you use least. One room a weekend adds up fast.

Prep that pays

- Fresh neutral paint
- New carpet or refreshed floors
- Small fixes buyers notice
- Deep clean and bright lighting

I can line up paint, flooring and touch ups with my own contractor, and you don't pay for the work until settlement.

Moving out of the family home? It's emotional, and that's okay. Take photos of the growth marks on the door frame. Save one box per child. We'll go at a pace that feels right.

STEP SIX

Buying land in *Carroll County*

More land comes with a few extra things to check. Here's my list before we write an offer.

- [ ] Well and septic inspections, plus water testing
- [ ] Heating type: propane, oil, heat pump or natural gas
- [ ] Zoning and any farmland preservation easements on the property
- [ ] Permits for barns, sheds, fencing, pools or animals
- [ ] Internet and cell service at the house, not just in town
- [ ] Commute to work, schools and the fields you drive to every week
- [ ] Driveway, snow removal and who maintains the road
- [ ] HOA or no HOA, and what that means for your plans

> Carroll County protects tens of thousands of acres of farmland, which is a big reason the open views stay open. I'll help you find land that fits your plans and your budget, in Maryland or just over the line in Pennsylvania.

REAL LIFE IN CARROLL COUNTY

What rightsizing *looks like here*

The moves I talk through with local families most often. Your version will have its own numbers, but one of these probably sounds familiar.

Done mowing, busy with travel sports

BEFORE A big lot with a big lawn. Three hours of mowing every week, and you're gone every Saturday for tournaments anyway.

AFTER A smaller yard, or a neighborhood where lawn care is covered or easy and affordable to hire out.

What made it work: trading grass you never sit on for weekends back with your family.

A flat yard for soccer practice

BEFORE A Westminster home on a hill. The backyard slopes so much the ball ends up in the neighbor's yard.

AFTER A flat, usable lot with room for a goal, a garden and the dog, often out toward the open farmland parts of the county.

What made it work: shopping for usable land, not just more acres.

Too much house, not enough land

BEFORE Five bedrooms, two of them storage, on a small suburban lot.

AFTER A house sized for how you actually live, on a few acres with space to roam.

What made it work: putting the budget into land instead of square footage.

The kids moved out

BEFORE A two story colonial with stairs, a big yard and rooms that stay closed.

AFTER Main level living close to Main Street dinners and the grandkids' games.

What made it work: selling first, then buying with the equity in hand.

Every family's numbers are different. These are example situations, not specific client results. Tell me yours and I'll show you what it could look like.

YOUR PLAN

Your 90 day *next chapter plan*

1. **Week 1:** 20 minute Next Chapter call and your custom home value report
2. **Weeks 2 to 3:** Talk with a trusted lender and pick buy first or sell first
3. **Weeks 3 to 6:** Sort, declutter and prep with my contractor
4. **Weeks 4 to 8:** Tour homes that fit your must haves
5. **Weeks 6 to 10:** List with photos, video and a launch plan
6. **Weeks 10 to 13:** Contracts, inspections and timed settlements. Move once.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Let's plan your next chapter

Book your free 20 minute Next Chapter call. No pressure, just a plan.

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Information is general and not financial or legal advice. Talk with your lender, attorney and tax advisor about your situation. Equal Housing Opportunity.